How Economists Discuss Central Bank Digital Currencies

Themes, Tone and Stance, 2014–2026

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Abstract

Keywords:
JEL codes:

1 Introduction

2 Related literature

2.1 Central bank digital currencies

2.2 What the field builds on

2.3 Bibliometric and text-as-data studies of CBDCs

3 Data

3.1 Sources and collection

3.2 De-duplication and enrichment

3.3 Relevance: is CBDC the theme?

3.4 Who counts as an economist

3.5 Descriptive statistics

4 Who writes

4.1 Method: co-citation, co-authorship, bibliometric laws and distinctive vocabulary

4.2 Findings

5 What is written

5.1 Method: thematic map, topic model and covariate-adjusted shares

5.2 Findings

*M2 – Private crypto.

6 How economists discuss CBDCs: tone and stance

6.1 Method: tone (FinBERT) and stance (reading and a local language model)

6.2 Findings

6.3 Do policy events move the tone?

7 Why: stated motivations

7.1 Method: a validated codebook

7.2 Findings

8 When: the policy environment

8.1 Method: bursts, event study with placebo dates, difference-in-differences

8.2 Findings

9 The discussion and its environment

9.1 Period by period

9.2 What can and cannot be said about causes

10 Robustness

11 Discussion

11.1 Limitations

12 Conclusion

Data and code availability

A Search vocabulary

B Harvesting algorithms

C Validation samples and coding guide

D Additional tables and figures